ACADEMIC CENTRAL

PRACTICE EXAMINATION

NC(V) LEVEL 2

ROBOTICS FUNDAMENTALS

PAPER 1 · PRACTICE B · MARKING GUIDELINE

MARKS: 100

Marking guideline for the Academic Central NC(V) Level 2 Robotics Fundamentals paper 1 · practice b.

Written by Academic Central for practice, following the NC(V) subject guidelines for NC(V) Level 2. It is not a Department of Higher Education and Training marking guideline.

How to mark: each ✓ is one mark. Give marks for the formula, the substitution and the answer with the correct unit. Use consistent accuracy. Accept other correct answers and examples.

SECTION A

QUESTION 1

1.1 A ✓
1.2 B ✓
1.3 C ✓
1.4 D ✓
1.5 B ✓
1.6 C ✓
1.7 A ✓
1.8 A ✓
1.9 B ✓
1.10 D ✓

(10 × 1) [10]

QUESTION 2

2.1 True ✓
2.2 True ✓
2.3 False ✓
2.4 True ✓
2.5 True ✓
2.6 False ✓
2.7 True ✓
2.8 False ✓
2.9 True ✓
2.10 False ✓

(10 × 1) [10]

QUESTION 3

3.1 C ✓
3.2 G ✓
3.3 I ✓
3.4 E ✓
3.5 B ✓
3.6 J ✓
3.7 A ✓

3.8 H ✓

3.9 D ✓

3.10 F ✓

(10 × 1) [10]

TOTAL SECTION A: [30]

SECTION B

QUESTION 4

4.1 A programmable machine that can sense its surroundings, make decisions and carry out tasks (act) automatically ✓✓ (2)

4.2 Any THREE ✓✓✓: Karel Čapek's play R.U.R. (1920) used the word "robot"; Isaac Asimov's three laws of robotics; George Devol and Joseph Engelberger built Unimate, the first industrial robot (1961), used by General Motors; the Mars rovers; the first robot vacuum cleaners; humanoid robots such as ASIMO. (3)

4.3 Any FOUR ✓✓✓✓: wheeled – fast on flat floors; tracked – tank tracks for rough or soft ground; legged / walking – can step over obstacles and climb stairs; flying – drones; underwater / swimming – submarine robots; rolling / spherical robots. (4)

4.4 Any FOUR ✓✓✓✓: work 24 hours without breaks; higher and more even quality; faster production; safer for workers (dangerous jobs); lower long-term costs; very accurate and repeatable; less waste. (4)

4.5 Dull – e.g. repeating the same assembly or packing task ✓; dirty – e.g. cleaning drains, painting, mining ✓; dangerous – e.g. bomb disposal, handling chemicals, exploring volcanoes or space ✓ (3)

[16]

QUESTION 5

5.1 Sense: bump, cliff and dirt sensors detect walls, stairs and dirt ✓; think: the controller decides where to go next ✓; act: the motors drive the wheels and brushes ✓. (3)

5.2 How it works ✓ and use ✓ for each: (a) touch switch – closes a contact when pressed – bumper to detect collisions; (b) IR reflective – sends infrared light and measures how much reflects back (black reflects less) – line following, edge detection; (c) ultrasonic – sends a sound pulse and times the echo – measuring distance, avoiding obstacles; (d) LDR – resistance falls as light increases – light-seeking robots, automatic headlights. (8)

5.3 $\mathrm{d} = (\mathrm{v} \times \mathrm{t}) \div 2 \checkmark = (340 \times 0{,}004) \div 2 \checkmark = 0{,}68\ \mathrm{m} \checkmark$ (3)

5.4 Any TWO differences ✓✓✓✓: a DC motor spins continuously, a servo turns to a set angle and holds it; a DC motor needs only a supply (speed by PWM), a servo needs a control signal; a servo has built-in gears and feedback (potentiometer); DC motors suit wheels, servos suit arms, grippers and steering. (4)

5.5 A small gear driving a large gear lowers the speed ✓ and increases the turning force (torque) by the same ratio ✓. (2)

[20]

QUESTION 6

6.1 One independent direction in which a robot or joint can move (move along or turn about an axis) ✓✓ (2)

6.2 Cartesian / gantry ✓, cylindrical ✓, spherical / polar ✓, articulated (and SCARA accepted) ✓. Description of ONE, e.g. Cartesian moves in three straight lines along X, Y and Z ✓ (5)

6.3.1 $v = \pi dN \div 60 \checkmark = \pi \times 0{,}06 \times 100 \div 60 \checkmark = 0{,}31 \text{ m/s} \checkmark$ (3)

6.3.2 $s = v \times t = 0{,}314 \times 10 = 3{,}14 \text{ m} \checkmark$ (1)

6.4 Each side has its own motor ✓. To turn left, the right wheel turns faster than the left (or the left wheel stops / reverses) ✓; to turn right, the left wheel turns faster ✓. (3)

6.5 Tracks spread the weight over a large area so the robot does not sink ✓ and they grip loose sand better than narrow wheels ✓. (2)

[16]

QUESTION 7

7.1 Any FOUR ✓✓✓✓: wear safety goggles; switch off and remove the battery before working on the robot; keep fingers away from wheels and gears; test on the floor or a stand, not at the edge of a table; check wiring for short circuits before switching on; keep the work area tidy; use tools correctly. (4)

7.2 Any TWO ✓✓: use the correct charger; never short-circuit the terminals; do not charge unattended or overnight; stop using a swollen, damaged or hot battery; store in a cool place / fire-safe bag. (2)

7.3 Any TWO explained ✓✓✓✓: job losses as robots replace workers; who is responsible if a robot causes harm; privacy – robots with cameras collect personal data; safety of robots working near people; use of robots in weapons; people relying too much on machines. (4)

7.4 Positive: new jobs in programming, maintenance and design / safer work ✓. Negative: some low-skilled jobs disappear ✓. (2)

7.5 Any FOUR ✓✓✓✓: charge and inspect the battery; check that screws and nuts are tight; clean the sensors; check wheels / tracks and gears for wear and hair or dirt; check wires and connectors; test the emergency stop and bumpers; update the software. (4)

7.6 A hacker could take control of the robot or steal its data ✓, which could cause damage or injury, so passwords, updates and secure connections are needed ✓. (2)

[18]

TOTAL SECTION B: [70]

TOTAL: 100

END OF MARKING GUIDELINE